

Subj: Blacklegged Kittewake
Date: 01/22/2000 7:58:10 PM Mountain Standard Time
From: oly@ecentral.com
To: NCSWPL@aol.com (Bill Lisowsky)

2000-64

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form (This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.) Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name)**Blacklegged Kittewake** (Scientific Name) *Rissa tridactyla*

Date(s) of occurrence: Jan. 22-2000

Number of birds seen: one **Sex:** ? **Plumage:** first winter basic

Exact location: sitting on the ice at the junction of roads 16 and HH in Bent county

County: **Nearest town:** Las Animas **Elevation:** John Martin Res

Length of observation: 3 - 4 minutes **Time(s) of observation:** approx. 11:10

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Dave Quesenberry

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): Chris Wood and Brandon

Percival

Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Party cloudy (cirrus type clouds), light wind from the west, observers facing the south with the sun in front of observer and off the left shoulder.

Optical equipment used: Kowa TSN4 with 20 X 60 lens

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Guess at 100 yards

Was bird(s) photographed? no If so, have you submitted photos?

Who took the photographs?

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: The bird was observed sitting on the ice at John Martin Res, the flying off to the east to open water.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): The bird was observed sitting on the ice with many RB Gulls, few He Gulls, Ca Gulls, Gl Gulls and a Th Gull. It then took flight and flew east to open water.

Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes): The bird was a smaller gull approx. the size of the surrounding RB gulls. Its bill was all black, slightly decurved and thinner than that of the RB gull. The head was white with a dark eye and a black circular patch half way between the eye and the back of the head. The back of the neck had a black collar that extended a bit more than half way around the neck. The throat, breast, belly were white. The mantle was light gray. The wings had a brownish - black stripe that ran from the shoulder to tertials on the resting bird. The primaries were brownish - black to black. The tail was white, slightly notched and had a black terminal band. The primaries extended past the tail, (I was unable to count to which primaries). The legs were dark and appeared short, You could only see them from the knee down.

Describe bird's call or song: none

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: Bonaparte's, Black-headed, Little and Ross's gulls were eliminated because of the neck collar. and the notched, banded tail. Sabine's gull was eliminated by the neck collar and the carpal bar.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen one first winter before.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this

influenced your identification (during and after observation): Nat. Geo. 2nd edition

This report is from notes made during X or after observation or later X from memory

Date of written report: Jan 22, 2000

Reporting observer: Ric Olson Signature:

Reporting Observer's Address :9450 N Heather Dr. Castle Rock Co 80104 303-790-7753

Send report to: Colorado Birds Record Committee c/o Bill Lisowsky 2919
Silverplume Dr. Ft. Collins, Co. 80526